

Hyper-Local Rent vs. Buy

Opportunity Cost Calculator

A rent-vs-buy calculator that doesn't ignore what your down payment could have earned you elsewhere.

Live now: onevvish.github.io/rentVsbuy

The Problem

Every rent-vs-buy calculator online asks the same lopsided question:

| "Is your monthly mortgage payment more or less than rent?"

That's the wrong comparison. It ignores the single biggest number in the decision:

What if you invested your down payment instead of locking it into a house?

A \$130K down payment invested in the market for 30 years can be worth **over a million dollars** on its own — most calculators pretend that opportunity doesn't exist.

The Solution

A calculator that runs the comparison honestly:

- **Buyer** — builds home equity, pays the mortgage, taxes, insurance, maintenance
- **Renter** — invests the down payment *and* whatever they save each month vs. the buyer's costs

Every dollar of "if you didn't buy, where would that money go?" is tracked, for 30 years, side by side.

Hyper-Local to California

Type a zip code, get real defaults for that market instantly:

- Home price & comparable rent
- Local property tax rate
- 35+ major CA metros mapped exactly; every other CA zip falls back to a regional estimate

Hyper-Local Rent vs. Buy Opportunity Cost Calculator

Most calculators ignore the opportunity cost of your down payment. This one invests it in the stock market and tracks a true 30-year net worth comparison.

[Pitch Deck](#) [Download PDF Report](#) [Share Scenario](#) [Save as My Defaults](#) [Reset to Defaults](#)

THE PROPERTY

Property Address

e.g. 123 Main St, San Jose, CA 95123

Zip Code (California)

94110

Loaded defaults for San Francisco (Mission)

Import from Zillow Screenshot

Home Price

\$1.4M

Monthly Rent (comparable)

\$3.4K

HOMEOWNERSHIP COSTS

Down Payment

20% (\$270K)

BREAK-EVEN POINT

Renting Wins

Over 30 years, investing the down payment beats buying in this scenario.

Mortgage (P&I) / mo

\$6,826

Buyer Net Worth (Yr 30)

\$3,026,955

Renter Net Worth (Yr 30)

\$5,514,722

30-Year Net Worth Projection

Deterministic

Monte Carlo



Skip the Typing

Drop in a screenshot of a Zillow listing — price, rent estimate, property tax, and HOA get pulled out automatically via on-device OCR. Nothing applies silently: every extracted value is shown for review first.

One Clear Answer: When Does Buying Win?

- **Break-even year** — the year buying's net worth overtakes renting's
- Full 30-year net worth chart for both paths
- Real costs modeled: mortgage, property tax, insurance, maintenance, selling costs

Hyper-Local Rent vs. Buy Opportunity Cost Calculator

Most calculators ignore the opportunity cost of your down payment. This one invests it in the stock market and tracks a true 30-year net worth comparison.

[Pitch Deck](#) [Download PDF Report](#) [Share Scenario](#) [Save as My Defaults](#) [Reset to Defaults](#)



Pick Your Own Investment

Not everyone would put the down payment in the stock market. Choose:

- **Stocks** — S&P 500
- **Treasury bonds** — steady, low-volatility
- **Gold** — no yield, historically choppy

Every option is backed by its own real 1987–2025 historical returns.

Beyond a Single Guess: Monte Carlo Risk

Markets don't move in a straight line. Toggle to see a **range of outcomes**, not just one — and a *correlated* one:

- 500 simulated 30-year scenarios, each year drawn from a real historical calendar year (1987–2025)
- Stock/bond/gold return AND home-price change for that simulated year come from the **same actual year** — a simulated 2008 pairs the real stock crash with the real housing downturn, not a random mismatch
- Result: "buying wins in 64% of outcomes" — with a real percentile range, not false precision

Hyper-Local Rent vs. Buy Opportunity Cost Calculator

Most calculators ignore the opportunity cost of your down payment. This one invests it in the stock market and tracks a true 30-year net worth comparison.

[Pitch Deck](#)[Download PDF Report](#)[Share Scenario](#)[Save as My Defaults](#)[Reset to Defaults](#)

THE PROPERTY

Property Address



BREAK-EVEN POINT (MEDIAN)

Year 10

In the median simulated scenario, buying overtakes renting in year 10.

Full Tax Picture, Not Just the Basics

Most calculators stop at property tax. This one models what actually shows up on a tax return:

Feature	What it captures
Prop 13 cap	CA property tax assessment capped at 2%/year growth
Itemized deductions	Mortgage interest + property tax vs. standard deduction
Section 121 exclusion	Home-sale gains tax-free up to \$250K / \$500K
Capital gains tax	On the renter's investment gains, federal + state

Make It Yours, Share It, Keep It

- **Property Address** — label exactly which listing you're analyzing
- **Save as My Defaults** — set your own baseline, reset back to it any time
- **Share Scenario** — one click encodes every input into a link; send someone your exact numbers, no accounts or re-entering data
- **Download PDF Report** — the full analysis, one click away

Take It Anywhere: Google Sheets

The full model — deterministic engine and all 500 Monte Carlo trials — also runs as a live-formula Google Sheet. Paste in one script, and every number recalculates from your own inputs, no web app required.

Try It Right Now

onevvish.github.io/rentVsbuy

Free. No sign-up. Live on GitHub Pages, auto-deployed on every update.

What's Next

- Expand hyper-local defaults beyond California
- Model PMI for buyers under 20% down
- CA rent-control caps (AB 1482) on the Rent Inflation assumption
- Upfront closing costs as part of the renter's invested capital

Questions?

onevvish.github.io/rentVsbuy
github.com/OneVVish/rentVsbuy